

INDIAN KNOWLEDGE SYSTEM

SHORT ANSWERS

1. What are the two main goals of Ayurveda?

1. Swasthasya Swasthya Rakshanam – to maintain the health of healthy individuals.
2. Aturasya Vikara Prashamanam – to cure the diseases of the sick.

2. How many Prakruthi types exist?

There are:

- Single-dosha types (Vata, Pitta, Kapha dominant),
- Dual-dosha types (e.g., Vata-Pitta, Pitta-Kapha),
- Tridoshic type (balanced).

3. How does Ayurveda approach treatment?

Ayurveda uses a holistic approach, focusing on:

- Removing root causes,
- Correcting imbalances,
- Using diet, lifestyle, medicines, and therapies,
- Preventing recurrence.

4. What is Agni & what is its importance?

Agni means digestive fire or metabolic energy responsible for digestion, absorption, and transformation of food into energy. Balanced Agni ensures good health, strength, and immunity. Impaired Agni leads to accumulation of toxins (Ama), causing various diseases.

5. How can we understand the language of the body?

The body communicates through symptoms, sensations, hunger, fatigue, and emotions. By being mindful of bodily signals—such as changes in appetite, digestion, sleep, or mood—we can understand what the body needs and maintain health through timely lifestyle and dietary adjustments.

6. How are Agni, Sara, and Ojas related to immunity.

Balanced Agni ensures proper digestion and nutrient absorption, leading to good Sara (healthy tissues). Healthy tissues in turn produce strong Ojas, which enhances immunity.

Hence, Agni → Sara → Ojas form a natural chain for maintaining immunity and wellness.

7. Write any two benefits of exercise?

- Improves digestion and circulation
- Increases strength and stamina
- Helps maintain ideal body weight
- Enhances mental clarity (any two)

8. Mention any four components of Dinacharya.

- Brahma Muhurta waking
- Tongue cleaning and oil pulling
- Exercise (Vyayama)
- Balanced meals at proper time
- Proper sleep hygiene (any four)

9. What is Dinacharya?

Dinacharya is the daily regimen prescribed by Ayurveda for maintaining health. It includes waking up early, elimination, oral hygiene, exercise, bath, timely food intake, work, rest, and sleep routines.

10. Define Raja Yoga?

Raja Yoga, described by Patanjali, emphasizes control of the mind through meditation and follows the eight steps of Ashtanga Yoga. It is known as the “royal path.”

11. Name the eight steps of Ashtanga Yoga.

1. Yama
2. Niyama
3. Asana
4. Pranayama
5. Pratyahara
6. Dharana
7. Dhyana
8. Samadhi

12. What is the relevance of yoga in the modern age?

Yoga helps manage stress, anxiety, lifestyle disorders, and mental fatigue. It improves flexibility, immunity, concentration, emotional balance, and supports a healthier modern lifestyle.

13. What is Triguna-based Psychology?

It is the study of human behavior based on the interplay of Sattva, Rajas, and Tamas, which influence emotions, thoughts, and actions.

14. What are the four aspects of the inner psychological system?

The four components are Manas (mind), Buddhi (intellect), Ahamkara (ego), and Chitta (memory/consciousness storehouse).

15. What is the role of Buddhi?

Buddhi represents intellect responsible for reasoning, discrimination, analysis, and decision-making.

LONG ANSWERS

16. Explain the role of Pancha Maha Bhutas in human Physiology?

- **Prithvi (Earth):** forms solid structures like bones, muscles.
- **Apas (Water):** maintains body fluids, blood plasma.
- **Tejas (Fire):** responsible for digestion, metabolism, vision.
- **Vayu (Air):** enables respiration, movement, nerve impulses.
- **Akasha (Space):** provides cavities, communication pathways.

Together, they form the structural and functional basis of the human body.

17. Write an essay on Prakruthi & its significance in Ayurveda?

- **Definition:** Prakruthi = natural constitution of an individual.
- **Formation:** Determined at conception based on Doshas.
- **Types:** Single, Dual, and Tridoshic.

Significance:

- Determines physical and mental tendencies.
- Helps predict susceptibility to diseases.
- Guides diet, lifestyle, and treatment for personalized healthcare.

18. Discuss the influence of Pancha Maha Bhutas on the human body with suitable examples.

Each Mahabhuta contributes to body structure and function:

- **Prithvi** → solidity (bones, teeth, muscles).
- **Apas** → fluids (blood, lymph).
- **Agni** → energy (digestion, vision, heat).
- **Vayu** → motion (breathing, circulation, nerve conduction).
- **Akasha** → space (mouth, nostrils, chest cavities).

Thus, the body is seen as a miniature of the universe (Pinda–Brahmanda concept).

19. Discuss health & treatment aspects in Ayurveda?

Ayurveda views health as a balanced state of body, mind, and spirit, maintained through the harmony of Doshas (Vata, Pitta, Kapha). It emphasizes prevention by promoting a healthy lifestyle, proper diet, daily routines (Dinacharya), and seasonal regimens (Ritucharya).

Treatment in Ayurveda follows two main approaches:

Shodhana (purification therapies like Panchakarma) and

Shamana (pacifying treatments using herbs, diet, and lifestyle changes).

Herbal medicines, yoga, meditation, and massage therapies are commonly used.

Ayurveda also focuses on strengthening Agni (digestive fire) and removing Ama (toxins) to restore health. Overall, its goal is to achieve long-term wellness by balancing internal energies and supporting natural healing.

20.Explain the concept of Dosha–Dhatu–Mala and their importance in maintaining health.

- **Doshas:** Functional principles (Vata–movement, Pitta–metabolism, Kapha–stability).

They regulate physiological processes.

- **Dhatu:** Seven structural tissues sustaining body and providing nourishment.

- **Malas:** Byproducts of metabolism necessary for balance.

Ayurveda believes that health exists when Doshas, Dhatus, and Malas are in equilibrium. Their imbalance causes diseases.

21.Define health according to Ayurveda and compare it with modern definition of health.

- Ayurveda: Health = balance of Dosha, Agni, Dhatu, Mala + harmony of soul, senses, and mind.

- Modern (WHO): Health = complete physical, mental, and social wellbeing, not merely absence of disease.

- Comparison: Both emphasize holistic wellbeing, but Ayurveda includes spiritual health as essential.

22.How does understanding body-mind communication help achieve perfect health?

Understanding body–mind communication is essential in Ayurveda because the mind strongly influences physical health and vice-versa. Thoughts, emotions, and stress directly affect the Doshas, which can disturb bodily functions if not balanced. By being aware of this connection, a person can manage stress, control emotions, and adopt positive thinking to maintain harmony. Practices like meditation, yoga, breathwork, and mindfulness help calm the mind and support the body’s healing processes. Balanced mind–body communication improves immunity, digestion, sleep, and overall energy levels. It also prevents the buildup of Ama (toxins) caused by negative mental states. When mind and body work together smoothly, Doshas remain stable, and perfect health can be achieved through natural, holistic balance.

23.Explain the concept of Koshta?

Koshta refers to the nature of the digestive tract and bowel movement tendency in a person. It is mainly of three types:

- **Mrudu Koshta:** Soft bowels, frequent motions.
- **Madhyama Koshta:** Moderate bowel habit (normal).
- **Krura Koshta:** Hard bowels, constipation tendency.

Understanding one's Koshta helps in planning proper diet and treatment methods.

24.Explain body-mind communication & how understanding the language of body improves health?

Body–mind communication is a dynamic interaction between thoughts, emotions, and physical responses. Ayurveda states that the body and mind are inseparable parts of health (Sharira–Manas Ekta).

Examples of communication:

- Stress causes headache, digestive issues
- Fear leads to increased heartbeat
- Happiness improves immunity
- Body signals like fatigue, hunger, or pain indicate imbalance

Understanding body language includes:

- Noticing appetite changes
- Sleep quality
- Energy levels
- Emotional shifts
- Pain or stiffness

When we listen to the body's signals, we can correct disturbances early through proper diet, rest, yoga, and lifestyle adjustments, preventing disease and supporting mental well-being.

25.How does Samanya & Vishesha principles apply in every aspect of life to achieve perfect health?

(OR)

26.How can the principles of Samanya and Vishesha be applied in daily life?

Samanya (Similarity Increases Qualities)

Consuming items with similar qualities increases that property.

Example:

- Eating oily foods increases oiliness in the body
- Warm food increases warmth in the body

Used when the body needs nourishment or strengthening.

Visesha (Opposites Reduce Qualities)

Opposite qualities reduce excess.

Example:

- Cold food reduces heat
- Light food reduces heaviness
- Sweet food reduces acidity

Application in daily life:

- **For excess heat (Pitta):** choose cooling foods (Visesha)
- **For sluggishness (Kapha):** choose light, warm foods
- **For anxiety (Vata):** choose warm, oily, grounding foods

Result:

Balanced doshas → physical and mental health → perfect wellbeing.

27. Explain Dravya, Guna and Karma & their relevance in maintaining health?

Ayurveda views every substance through three aspects:

1. Dravya (Substance)

Everything we consume or experience (food, medicine, environment).

2. Guna (Quality)

Each dravya has qualities like hot/cold, heavy/light, oily/dry.

3. Karma (Action)

The effect produced in the body, such as cooling, heating, nourishing, cleansing.

Example:

- Milk (Dravya)
- Qualities: cooling, heavy, sweet (Guna)
- Action: nourishes, builds Ojas (Karma)

Understanding these helps in choosing food and medicines to balance doshas and promote wellbeing.

28. Explain Sadvritta & its role in social well-being?

Introduction:

Sadvritta refers to good conduct essential for mental and social harmony.

Principles of Sadvritta:

- **Personal hygiene:** Cleanliness of body and surroundings
- **Mental discipline:** Avoid anger, jealousy, and negative emotions
- **Moral values:** Truthfulness, honesty, compassion
- **Social behavior:** Respect for elders, kindness to all beings
- **Speech discipline:** speaking polite and meaningful words
- **Lifestyle practices:** Self-control, punctuality, moderation in desires

Role in Mental & Social Wellbeing:

- Promotes peaceful relationships
- Reduces stress and anxiety
- Improves moral character and societal harmony
- Enhances emotional balance

Conclusion:

Sadvritta ensures overall wellbeing by harmonizing body, mind, and society.

29. Explain the concept of Shadrassa & its importance in nutrition?

Introduction:

Shadrassa are the six tastes in Ayurveda that influence health, digestion, and dosha balance.

Six Tastes and Their Properties:

1. **Madhura (Sweet):** Builds tissues, nourishes, increases Kapha.

2. **Amla (Sour):** Stimulates appetite, increases Pitta and Kapha.
3. **Lavana (Salty):** Enhances digestion, increases water retention.
4. **Katu (Pungent):** Increases metabolism, reduces Kapha.
5. **Tikta (Bitter):** Detoxifies, reduces Pitta and Kapha.
6. **Kashaya (Astringent):** Absorbs moisture, reduces Pitta.

Importance:

- Ensures balanced nutrition
- Maintains digestive health
- Balances doshas
- Prevents diseases related to food imbalance

30. Describe the concept of human body constitution (Prakruthi) & factors influencing its formation?

Prakruthi refers to the natural body–mind constitution of an individual, formed at conception and remaining constant throughout life. It is determined by the unique proportion of the three Doshas—Vata, Pitta, and Kapha—present in the body. This constitution influences a person's physical features, mental tendencies, immunity, digestion, and overall health. Factors influencing Prakruthi formation include the parents' Dosha balance, their diet and lifestyle during conception, and the condition of the mother's womb. The season and time of conception, as well as the emotional and physical state of the parents, also play an important role. Prakruthi helps understand a person's strengths, vulnerabilities, and disease tendencies. Knowing one's constitution allows for personalized diet, lifestyle, and treatment for maintaining optimal health.

31. Discuss in detail the healthy lifestyle under Dinacharya & Ritucharya for disease prevention?

Dinacharya refers to the daily routine prescribed in Ayurveda to maintain health and prevent diseases. It includes waking up early (Brahma Muhurta), drinking warm water, practicing oral hygiene, doing Abhyanga (oil massage), regular exercise, yoga, meditation, and eating meals at proper times. These habits help balance the Doshas, improve digestion, enhance immunity, and maintain mental clarity.

Ritucharya refers to seasonal routines that adjust lifestyle and diet according to changes in climate. It suggests specific foods, clothing, and activities for each season to prevent seasonal imbalances of Doshas. For example, cooling foods in summer, warming foods in winter, and cleansing practices during seasonal transitions. By following Dinacharya and Ritucharya, the body adapts naturally to daily and seasonal changes, reducing disease risk and promoting long-term well-being.

32. Explain Dinacharya in detail.

Introduction:

Dinacharya means daily regimen. Ayurveda recommends a structured daily routine to maintain biological rhythms, prevent diseases, and promote physical and mental health. Components of Dinacharya:

1. **Brahma Muhurta Jagarana:** Waking early promotes mental clarity and freshness.
2. **Sharira Shuddhi:** Natural elimination of urine and feces.
3. **Oral Hygiene:** Tongue scraping, brushing, oil pulling (Gandusha), and nasal cleansing (Nasya).
4. **Dincharya Abhyanga:** Oil massage to nourish tissues and reduce Vata.
5. **Vyayama (Exercise):** Improves strength, digestion, metabolism, posture; done up to half strength.
6. **Snana (Bathing):** Enhances cleanliness and mental freshness.
7. **Food Intake:** Timely meals, freshly prepared food, major meal at noon.
8. **Work Routine & Ergonomics:** Balanced mental and physical work with proper posture.
9. **Rest & Sleep Hygiene:** Regular sleeping time, calm environment, and adequate sleep.

Conclusion:

Dinacharya maintains harmony of doshas, enhances immunity, and prevents lifestyle-related disorders.

33. Discuss Trividha Upastambhas in detail.

(OR)

34. What are the three pillars of health. Explain their significance.

Introduction:

The body is supported by three pillars—Ahara, Nidra, and Brahmacharya. These maintain health, strength, and longevity.

1. Ahara (Food):

- Primary source of nourishment
- Should be wholesome, timely, and suitable to prakriti
- Influences immunity, digestion, energy, and mental clarity

2. Nidra (Sleep):

- Restores body tissues and mental functions
- Lack of sleep leads to fatigue, memory loss, anxiety, and illness
- Good sleep enhances immunity and metabolism

3. Brahmacharya (Balanced use of sexual energy):

- Conservation of vital energy (ojas)
- Maintains mental stability and self-control
- Avoids excessive indulgence that can weaken body and mind

Conclusion:

These three pillars support optimal health, just as pillars support a building.

35. Define Yoga. Explain the meaning & objectives of Yoga?

Definition & Meaning:

Yoga comes from Yuj meaning union, integration, or joining. It signifies the union of body, mind, and consciousness. Yoga is both a philosophy and a discipline that guides a person toward harmony and self-realization.

Objectives of Yoga:

1. **Physical wellbeing:** Improves strength, flexibility, immunity.

2. **Mental peace:** Reduces stress, anxiety, and emotional disturbances.
3. **Self-discipline:** Inculcates control over senses and mind.
4. **Spiritual growth:** Leads to self-awareness and inner peace.
5. **Balanced lifestyle:** Encourages moderation in food, behavior, and attitudes.
6. **Liberation (Moksha):** Ultimate freedom from suffering and ignorance.

Conclusion:

Yoga aims at the holistic development of individual—physical, mental, emotional, and spiritual.

36. Write a brief note on Hatha Yoga & Raja Yoga?

Hatha Yoga is a branch of yoga that focuses on physical postures (asanas), breathing techniques (pranayama), and purification practices to prepare the body for higher spiritual work. It aims to balance the body's energies, increase strength, flexibility, and improve overall health.

Raja Yoga, also known as the “Royal Path,” emphasizes control of the mind through meditation, concentration, and ethical discipline. It follows Patanjali's Ashtanga Yoga, which includes Yama, Niyama, Asana, Pranayama, Pratyahara, Dharana, Dhyana, and Samadhi. While Hatha Yoga disciplines the body, Raja Yoga trains the mind, leading to inner peace and self-realization.

37. Write a brief note on Hatha Yoga, Raja Yoga, Karma Yoga, Jnana Yoga, and Bhakti Yoga.

Hatha Yoga:

Focuses on physical purification through asanas, pranayama, bandhas, and kriyas. It prepares the body for higher spiritual practices.

Raja Yoga:

Also called Ashtanga Yoga (Patanjali Yoga). Emphasizes control of the mind through eight steps: yama, niyama, asana, pranayama, pratyahara, dharana, dhyana, and samadhi.

Karma Yoga:

Path of selfless action performed without desire for reward. It purifies the mind, reduces ego, and promotes detachment.

Jnana Yoga:

Yoga of knowledge and wisdom involving inquiry into true Self. Practices include sravana (listening), manana (reflection), and nididhyasana (meditation).

Bhakti Yoga:

Path of devotion and surrender to the divine. It purifies emotions and cultivates unconditional love, faith, and unity with the divine.

38. Discuss the relevance of yoga in modern age?

Introduction:

In fast-paced modern life, people face stress, sedentary habits, pollution, anxiety, and lifestyle disorders. Yoga provides a natural remedy for these issues.

Relevance of Yoga Today:

- Stress management: Through relaxation, pranayama, and meditation.

- Prevention of lifestyle diseases: Beneficial in diabetes, hypertension, obesity, heart diseases.
- Mental health: Increases concentration, emotional stability, reduces depression and anxiety.
- Improved immunity: Supports overall health.
- Countering sedentary lifestyle: Asanas help maintain strength and flexibility.
- Spiritual balance: Provides peace, purpose, and clarity in life.
- Work-life balance: Encourages mindfulness and discipline.

Conclusion:

Yoga is relevant and essential for modern lifestyle, promoting holistic wellbeing.

39.Explain the eight steps of Ashtanga Yoga.

Introduction:

Ashtanga Yoga, described by Sage Patanjali, consists of eight limbs that guide personal, physical, mental, and spiritual discipline.

1. Yama:

Moral restraints—Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya, Aparigraha.

2. Niyama:

Personal observances—Shaucha, Santosha, Tapas, Svadhyaya, Ishvarapranidhana.

3. Asana:

Physical postures to prepare the body, strengthen muscles, and promote steadiness.

4. Pranayama:

Regulation of breath to control life force (Prana).

5. Pratyahara:

Withdrawal of senses from external objects.

6. Dharana:

Concentration—holding the mind steadily on one object.

7. Dhyana:

Meditation—continuous flow of awareness.

8. Samadhi:

State of blissful union with the Self; highest realization.

Conclusion:

These steps help achieve physical discipline, mental mastery, and spiritual liberation.

40.What is consciousness. Explain its level according to Indian Psychology?

Consciousness (Chaitanya) is the fundamental awareness that enables perception, experience, and existence. It is considered eternal and pure in Indian philosophy.

Levels of consciousness:

1. **Jagrat** (Waking State) – sensory awareness, interaction with the external world.
2. **Swapna** (Dream State) – mental experiences without sensory input.
3. **Sushupti** (Deep Sleep) – no awareness, but blissful rest.
4. **Turiya** (Pure Consciousness) – transcendental state achieved through meditation; beyond waking, dreaming, and deep sleep.

Understanding consciousness helps manage emotions, stress, and mental suffering.

41. Explain the influence of Tridosha on the mind?

According to Ayurveda, Vata, Pitta, and Kapha not only regulate physical functions but also affect mental nature.

Vata Dosha (Air element)

- Controls movement of thoughts
- Excess leads to fear, worry, anxiety
- Balanced Vata → creativity, quick thinking

Pitta Dosha (Fire element)

- Controls intellect and decision-making
- Excess leads to anger, irritability, aggression
- Balanced Pitta → sharp intellect, leadership

Kapha Dosha (Water/Earth element)

- Controls stability and memory
- Excess leads to laziness, attachment, depression
- Balanced Kapha → calmness, patience, compassion

Thus, mental health depends on the balance of the tridoshas.

42. Describe the Mind–Body–Intellect–Consciousness complex.

Indian psychology divides the inner world into four parts:

1. **Manas (Mind)** – receives sensory inputs, emotions, thoughts.
2. **Buddhi (Intellect)** – analysis, judgment, decision-making.
3. **Ahamkara (Ego)** – sense of identity (“I” consciousness).
4. **Chitta (Memory)** – impressions, habits, deep memories.

These four together form the Antahkarana (inner instrument).

Interactions:

- Manas processes thoughts, Buddhi evaluates them.
- Ahamkara identifies with actions and experiences.
- Chitta stores impressions which shape personality.

This complex governs human behavior, emotional responses, learning, memory, and consciousness evolution.

43. Describe Triguna based Psychology in Ayurveda & Yoga?

Indian psychology explains human nature through the three gunas:

- **Sattva:** purity, wisdom, clarity
- **Rajas:** activity, desire, passion
- **Tamas:** inertia, ignorance, dullness

These gunas exist in every individual in varying proportions.

Influence on human behavior:

- A Sattvic mind is peaceful, balanced, and knowledgeable.
- A Rajasic mind is restless, ambitious, aggressive.
- A Tamasic mind is lazy, confused, and negative.

Role in Yoga & Ayurveda:

- Yoga practices increase Sattva.

- Ayurveda recommends diet and lifestyle to reduce excess Rajas and Tamas.
 - Mental disorders arise when Rajas or Tamas dominate.
- Triguna-based psychology helps understand personality, emotions, habits, and mental wellness.

44. Discuss solutions to issues within the human mind based on Ayurveda and Yoga.

Indian systems suggest holistic ways to manage mental problems such as stress, anxiety, anger, depression, and restlessness.

Ayurvedic Solutions

- Balanced diet supporting Sattva
- Daily routines (dinacharya)
- Herbal support: Brahmi, Ashwagandha, Shankhpushpi
- Sleep regulation

Yogic Solutions

- Meditation for mental clarity
- Pranayama for emotional control
- Asanas for physical relaxation
- Yoga Nidra for stress relief

Lifestyle & Behavioral Solutions

- Positive thinking
- Self-discipline
- Healthy relationships
- Time management
- Gratitude and mindfulness

These practices restore balance of gunas, doshas, and the mind-body complex.

45. Explain the concept of Manas in Ayurveda and its functions.

In Ayurveda, Manas means the mind, considered an important internal organ (antarindriya). It controls perception, thought process, emotions, and decision-making. Manas acts as a bridge between the external senses and the deeper consciousness.

Key functions of Manas:

1. **Chintana** – thinking
2. **Vichara** – analysis
3. **Samshaya** – doubting
4. **Nischaya** – determination
5. **Uha** – reasoning
6. **Dhyana** – concentration

Ayurveda states that mental imbalance affects the body and vice versa. Therefore, Manas plays a central role in health, behavior, and personality.